

Crunchwell — Q2 FY2026 Brand Business Review

The \$312M flagship: share held, revenue behind plan, and the equity signal driving both

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National value share	6.0% — held flat (Acme #4 RTE)
Q2 net revenue vs plan	\$47.5M vs \$50.4M plan · -5.8%
Louisiana DMA share	6.4% → 3.0% (–340 bps, peak-to-trough)
Brand equity — Relevance	68.6 → 62.7 T2B (–5.9 pp)
Near-term bet	Pack Refresh — Hero SKUs, launches 2026-08-15 (\$28M yr1)

Executive summary

Crunchwell held its national footprint in Q2 FY2026 — value share sits at 6.0%, flat across six quarters — but ran -5.8% behind a \$50M plan, the same 5.7–6.0% gap the brand has carried every month of the fiscal year. The revenue miss is not a broad demand collapse; it is two things stacked. First, a regional wound: Louisiana share has fallen from a 6.4% Mass/Grocery peak to 3.0%, –340 bps. Second, and more strategic, a slow erosion of brand **Relevance** — down 5.9 points of top-two-box while Trust and Quality hold. Crunchwell is still trusted; it is drifting from cultural relevance. The Q2 job is to stabilise the number while the Pack Refresh and a targeted innovation slate re-earn relevance.

- **Share held, revenue didn't:** national value share 6.0% (flat); Q2 net revenue \$47.5M vs \$50.4M plan (-5.8%). The gap is structural to FY26, not a new deterioration.
- **Louisiana is the acute problem:** –340 bps of local share (6.4% → 3.0%). Recovery is scoped and funded — see the turnaround plan, Report 24, and the South-region read, Report 39.
- **Relevance is the lead diagnostic:** 68.6 → 62.7 T2B (–5.9 pp). Trust holds at ~73. Social sentiment runs -0.11 on 316 2026 mentions — a soft-negative signal.
- **The forward bet:** the Pack Refresh (Hero SKUs, \$28M yr-1, launches 2026-08-15) is the biggest near-term innovation and the anchor of both the relevance rebuild and the LA recovery.

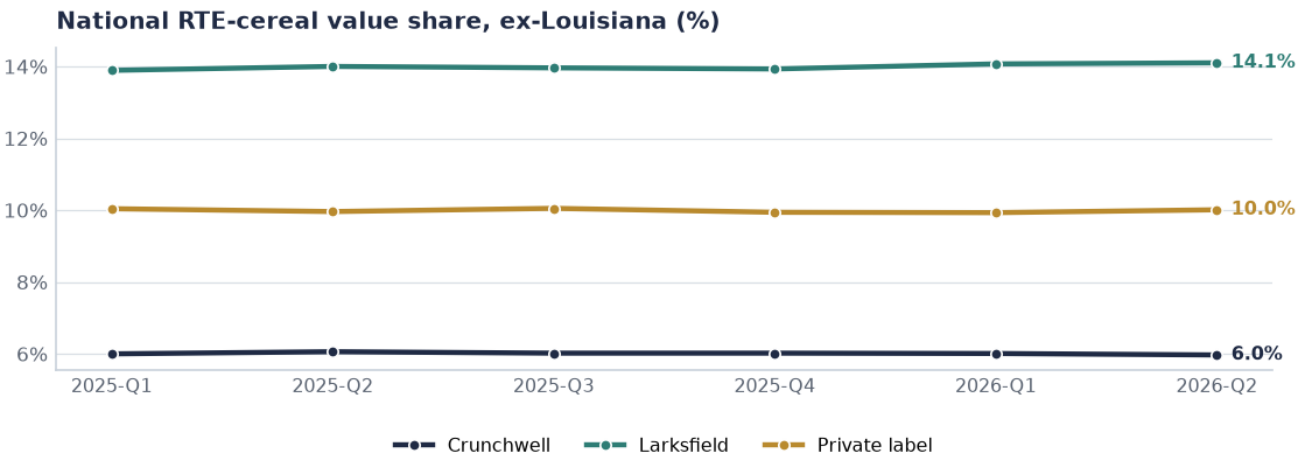
1 · Brand scorecard

NET REVENUE (Q2)	NATL VALUE SHARE	RELEVANCE (T2B)	LOUISIANA SHARE	SOCIAL SENTIMENT
\$47.5M -5.8% vs plan	6.0% flat, 6 qtrs	62.7 –5.9 pp vs FY25Q1	3.0% –340 bps p-to-t	-0.11 316 mentions '26

The scorecard is amber. The franchise is intact at the national level — share, distribution and Trust are stable — but two indicators are red: Louisiana share and brand Relevance. Both point at the same underlying issue, a brand that is respected but no longer feels current to the shopper. Everything downstream of that — the revenue gap, the sentiment reading, the LA erosion accelerating where a modern challenger (Larksfield / Field & Honey) presses hardest — is a symptom of it.

1.1 · National share is stable — the problem is not the base

Across six quarters Crunchwell's national value share holds at 6.0%, with Larksfield the share gainer at ~14.0% and private label steady near 10.0%. Read plainly: this is not a national franchise in decline. The base is holding. That is exactly why the revenue gap and the Louisiana collapse deserve a surgical response rather than a wholesale relaunch — we are defending a stable, profitable core, not rescuing a franchise in free-fall.



National value share, ex-LA. Crunchwell flat at 6.0%; Larksfield the national gainer.

Source: syndicated_weekly (RTE Cereal, ex LA-DMA), quarterly averages 2025-W01 → 2026 partial.

2 · The revenue gap, sized

2.1 · Net revenue vs plan — FY26 monthly

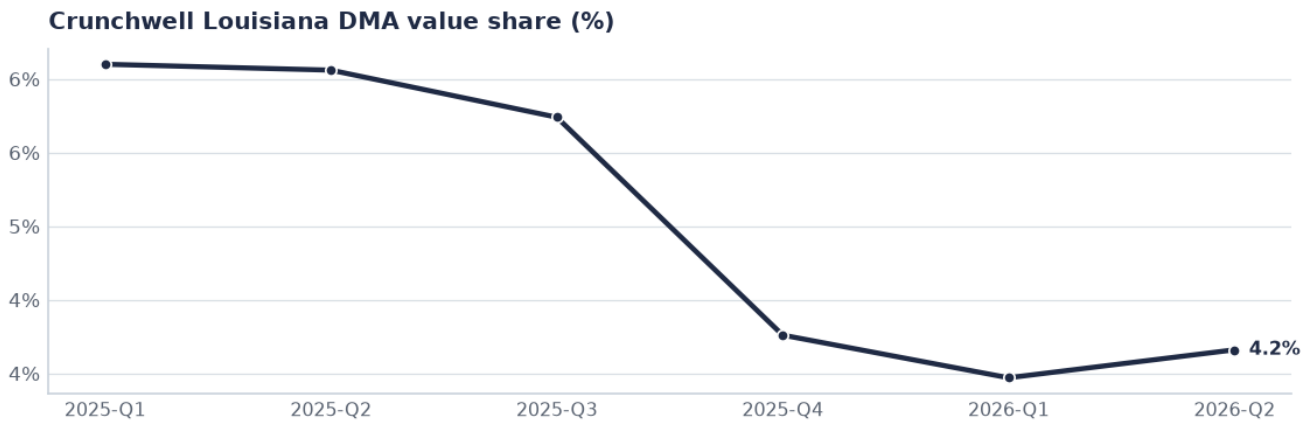
Month	Plan	Actual	Var %
2026-01	\$25.19M	\$23.75M	−5.7%
2026-02	\$25.19M	\$23.66M	−6.0%
2026-03	\$25.19M	\$23.69M	−5.9%
2026-04	\$25.19M	\$23.70M	−5.9%
2026-05	\$25.19M	\$23.75M	−5.7%

Source: plan_vs_actual (Acme ERP shape), Crunchwell brand, FY26 periods through May.

The gap is remarkably consistent — 5.7 to 6.0% behind plan, every month. Consistency matters: it says the miss is structural (a plan set above where the brand is actually running, compounded by the Louisiana hole) rather than a fresh deterioration or an execution wobble. The absolute drag is roughly \$1.5M/month, ~\$18M annualised, and a material fraction of that traces to a single DMA.

3 · Louisiana — −340 bps of local share

Louisiana is the acute wound inside a stable body. The canonical headline (Mass/Grocery, peak-to-trough) is 6.4% → 3.0%, −340 bps; the value-weighted all-channel cut is milder — Crunchwell LA-DMA value share ran 6.1% in early FY25 and troughed at 4.0% in Q1 FY26 before a partial bounce to 4.2% in Q2 — but the direction is identical. New Orleans (5.1 → 3.0) and Baton Rouge (5.8 → 4.2) are the sharpest metros. The root cause is multi-factor: a Walmart modular reset that cut facings, Larksfield promo intensity, residual Hurricane Tonya supply disruption, private-label pressure, and a Hispanic-shopper mix the brand under-serves. The scoped, funded three-leg recovery lives in the turnaround plan (Report 24); the South-region operating detail is in Report 39.



LA-DMA all-channel value share: trough in Q1 FY26, early Q2 stabilisation. Headline peak-to-trough (Mass/Grocery) is 6.4% → 3.0%.

Louisiana is where the relevance gap gets exploited

The category itself is shrinking in Louisiana (RTE total ~\$38M/qtr, -2.8%). Into that softness, a modern challenger presses on facings and promo. A trusted-but-dated brand is most exposed exactly where an aggressor is most active. LA is the national relevance problem, playing out fast in one DMA.

4 · Brand equity — Relevance, not Trust

The single most important diagnostic on this brand: **Relevance** has fallen 68.6 → 62.7 top-two-box (–5.9 pp) over five waves, while **Trust** is flat-to-up (72.3 → 72.9) and **Quality** holds (69.3 → 70.3). Taste is essentially stable; Modernity is soft (51.0 → 48.8). The pattern is unambiguous. Consumers still trust Crunchwell and rate its quality — they are simply deciding it matters less to them. That is a relevance problem, and it is fixable with modernization (pack, format, cultural fit) rather than a trust rebuild, which would be far slower and costlier.

Crunchwell brand equity, top-two-box % (US-NAT)



Relevance and Modernity slip; Trust, Quality and Taste hold. The gap to close is relevance.

Source: brand_equity_quarterly (Kantar-shape, US-NAT), waves FY25Q1 and FY26Q2; social_mentions 2026.

5 · The innovation response

5.1 · Pack Refresh — the anchor bet (launch 2026-08-15)

The Crunchwell Pack Refresh (Hero SKUs) is in Stage-5 Launch Prep at \$28M year-one and confidence 0.82 — the biggest near-term innovation in the company and the anchor of both the relevance rebuild and the Louisiana recovery (it is Leg 3 of the LA plan). Visual modernization directly targets the Relevance and Modernity gap without touching the Trust/Quality equity we want to protect. Launch is 2026-08-15.

5.2 · The relevance-and-reach slate behind it

Two concepts extend the thesis. The Hispanic **Maiz Crunch** format (Stage-2 Concept, \$12M year-one, confidence 0.46, planned 2027-Q1) addresses a real gap — Crunchwell penetration in Hispanic households runs ~4.1% vs ~11.7% non-Hispanic — and is directly tied to the Louisiana Hispanic-shopper hypothesis. The **Cinnamon Twist reformulation** (Stage-3, recovery track) rescues an underperforming SKU (CR006, launched 2025 at ~41% ACV) flagged on negative review themes — reformulate or delist by Q3. FY27+ revenue figures here are planning estimates, not booked volume.

Innovation slate — near-term

Concept	Stage	Yr-1 (plan)	Launch	Role
Pack Refresh — Hero SKUs	Stage-5 Launch Prep	\$28.0M	2026-08-15	Relevance + LA anchor
Hispanic Maiz Crunch	Stage-2 Concept	\$12.0M	2027-Q1 (plan)	Reach / LA Hispanic
Cinnamon Twist reformulation	Stage-3 Prototype	Recovery	2026-Q4 (plan)	SKU rescue

Source: *innovation_pipeline.csv* (INV001, INV002, INV022). Year-1 revenue = planning estimate for FY27+ items.

Watch-items into Q3

(1) Pack Refresh execution — an \$28M launch on 2026-08-15 must land clean; it is carrying two strategic jobs. (2) Louisiana stabilisation must hold and extend beyond the Q2 partial bounce. (3) Relevance is a slow-moving metric; expect the pack change to show in shipment and velocity before it shows in the tracker.

Recommendations & next steps

#	Action	Owner	When
1	Land the Pack Refresh on 2026-08-15 with full retail support; treat it as the relevance-rebuild anchor.	Cory Whitman / Audrey Kim	Aug — now
2	Execute the funded Louisiana three-leg recovery (facings, targeted trade, LA retail media). See Report 24 / 39.	Marcus Boudreaux	Q3 — now
3	Advance Maiz Crunch through Stage-2 to close the Hispanic-HH penetration gap tied to LA.	Lillian Park	FY27 planning
4	Resolve Cinnamon Twist: reformulate on review-driven fixes or delist by Q3.	Lillian Park	Q3 gate
5	Hold the FY26 Crunchwell number; report the relevance tracker monthly against pack-change milestones.	Cory Whitman / Finance	Monthly MBR